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FOR: **MAPLE LEAF FOODS INC.**

TSX SYMBOL: MFI

AUGUST 22, 2003 - 14:25 ET

Maple Leaf Foods Purchases Canada Bread Shares

TORONTO, ONTARIO--Maple Leaf Foods today announced that it has entered into a private agreement with a third-party to purchase 903,100 common shares of Canada Bread Company, Limited at $26.50 per share. The transaction is expected to close on August 24, 2003.

The shares were purchased for investment purposes. "The purchase further demonstrates Maple Leaf Foods' long-term commitment to the bakery business." said Tom P. Muir, Chief Financial Officer of Maple Leaf Foods. Maple Leaf Foods may or may not purchase additional shares of Canada Bread in the future, depending on market conditions.

Prior to this transaction, Maple Leaf Foods beneficially owned 20,618,015 common shares representing approximately 81.1% of the outstanding common shares. Subsequent to the transaction Maple Leaf Foods will own 21,521,115 common shares representing approximately 84.7% of the outstanding common shares of Canada Bread.

Maple Leaf Foods, Inc. is a leading Canadian food processing company committed to delivering quality food products to consumers around the world. Headquartered in Toronto, Canada, the Company employs more than 18,000 people at its operations across Canada, and in the United States, Europe and Asia. Maple Leaf Foods Inc. reported sales of $5.1 billion in 2002.

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